

Mike Speight – User Interface developer

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About Me:

Name: Mike Speight
Nationality: English
Location: Lingfield, Surrey
Interested in: Contract work only
Availability: Immediately available

I have been working as a professional web developer since the late nineties and in other roles within the IT industry before that. My primary discipline is that of Front-End/User Interface Developer. Although I have a lot of experience of using Photoshop and other products in the Adobe Creative Suite to produce, cut and optimise graphics and have some design skills, I am not a Graphic Designer.

Skills and technologies

HTML/XHTML CSS: - These are the core skills of any Front-End/User Interface developer, I have been using these skills since the late nineties, and have now been using the latest versions of these technologies, HTML5 and CSS3, since their first appearance. I have also been employing some of the latest techniques, libraries and related technologies, such as OOCSS, Bootstrap and the use of pre compilers LESS and SASS. Taking into account the fast rate of change within the web industry, and the many ways our products are being consumed by the user on a variety of devices, I am using modern methods such as Mobile-First and Responsive Design to produce Interfaces that meet the demands of today's web.

JavaScript: - I have been coding JavaScript since the late nineties and have been using it to manipulate the DOM for just as long, and doesn't present an obstacle as I started in the IT industry as a C programmer. Writing native JavaScript is not a problem, as I am just as comfortable coding with that as using a library such as jQuery etc. As the industry undergoes rapid change and the emphasis changes from Websites more towards Web Applications, I have tried to keep up to date with the latest JavaScript libraries and frameworks, such as: jQuery, jQuery UI, Knockout, Backbone, Underscore, Modernizer and more lately, Node and Angular. I spend quite a bit of time trying to keep pace as new frameworks and libraries emerge. I am also completely conversant with the use of the data transfer/storage technologies like: AJAX, JSON and the newer HTML5 technologies of: WebSockets and Local Storage. Given the increasing popularity of JavaScript Applications and the transfer of processing from the server to the client, it is imperative to develop these applications in a structured manor and to produce hi-quality code, therefore I am endeavouring to use processes like BDD/TDD and Unit Testing, especially important in Agile environments.

Server Technologies: - Over the time I have developed the front-end against quite a few different back-end server technologies and am competent with all. However during the time spent working for EMC/Conchango, who were primarily a Microsoft house I became skilled in developing the front ends for the Microsoft platform, in particular Server Controls and mark-up and the setting up and the use of Master Pages and nested Master Pages. This is a great help when having to style pages developed on Microsoft technologies.

CMS: - Over the years, I have worked on projects that have used various Content Management Systems, both Open Source and Microsoft based, including: Drupal, Wordpress, Joomla, Umbraco, Orchard, N2, Sitecore, among others.

Agile methodology: - While working for a company who championed Agile and Scrum in particular (Conchango). I have undergone several Agile training courses, i.e. "User Stories for Agile Requirements", "Agile Estimating and Planning", and I am a certified ScrumMaster. I have used these skills in a few contracts to aid the companies to adopt agile methodologies.

Areas of focus: - I continue to spend time researching and reading about new technologies as they appear, in order to improve my base skill-set and keep abreast of industry trends. I am also keen to keep abreast of some of the associated web technologies such as: SEO/Search Engine Optimisation, website optimisation, and analytics techniques, in an effort to maintain and develop a holistic skill-set.

Self Employment – Contracting:

Hotels4u/Thomas Cook - <http://www.hotels4u.com>

Mar 2014 – Sept 2014: Senior User Interface Developer. Since March this year I have been engaged by Hotels4u.com, who are part of the Thomas Cook group, to produce the front-end/UI for their new responsive, hotel search and booking, ecommerce site. My responsibilities included, producing all page layouts and styling, including media queries to enable the site to render correctly across a full range of devices, from mobiles in portrait mode, to large desktop displays, also to enable the site to offer different functionality dependant on display size. – HTML5, CSS/CSS3, Responsive Design/Media Queries, Object Orientated JavaScript, jQuery, Angular, AJAX, LESS, Grunt, Jasmine, Twitter Bootstrap3.

Pearson - <http://www.pearson.com>

Oct 2013 – Mar 2014: I was contracted by this global publishing company, primarily to build and style the user interface to an XML based Global Content Authoring system. The system was built around the XOPUS XML editor and provided an interface that enabled authors to enter content to be stored in an XML schema that allowed it to be output to be in multiple formats. I also developed the front end to Pearson's CHORUS (Content Hub, Organise, Re-Use, and Share) Extranet application. – HTML5, CSS/CSS3, Responsive Design/ Media Queries, Object Orientated JavaScript, jQuery, Underscore, AJAX, SASS, Twitter Bootstrap, XML, XSLT, XOPUS, Extranet.

The Rumpus Room - <http://therumpusroom.tv>

Aug 2013 – Sept 2013: Senior User Interface Developer. I was engaged by this interactive media/video production agency to build a responsive front end for an interactive web application for L'Oreal advertising campaign for their Studio Line #Txt range that was required to work across a range of devices, with differences in functionality depending on the device being used. The application allowed users to upload a number of images or short videos that are then edited together with various pre-recorded video clips and a sound track, to produce a final video that can then be previewed, added to the site and entered into a competition via social media. – HTML5, CSS/CSS3, Responsive Design/ Media Queries, Object Orientated JavaScript, HTML5 Video, jQuery, Modernizer, AJAX, LESS.

Sportlabs Technology - <http://www.sportlabs.com>

Jan 2013– July 2013: Senior User Interface Developer/ Agile Coach /Project Manager.

Because of my wide range of experience, I was contracted by this small start-up company, who specialise in sports related sites and mobile applications, to provide support in a variety of areas. My primary function was to help develop the web side of a tournament planning application for the Lawn Tennis Association, also some work on the UEFA web site for the Respect Campaign. – HTML5, CSS3, Responsive Design/ Media Queries, Object Orientated JavaScript, jQuery, Knockout, Underscore, Parse, AJAX, Umbraco, Agile.

Micros Fidelio - <http://www.micros-fidelio.co.uk>

Oct 2012 – Jan 2013: Senior User Interface Developer.

I worked for this e-commerce solutions vendor, to work on various hospitality, travel and retail sites including <http://www.thorntons.co.uk> and <http://scottishpassport.currencyandmore.com> adding new functionality. – HTML5, CSS/CSS3, Object Orientated JavaScript, jQuery, Knockout, Underscore AJAX, Orchard (.net) CMS, LESS, Twitter Bootstrap.

Tesco.com

Aug 2012 – Oct 2012: Senior User Interface Developer.

I was engaged by this major retailer, to work as part of a team to adding new functionality to enable the introduction of product variants to the <http://www.tesco.com/direct> product detail and product listing pages.

Also to investigate and recommend improvements to working methods and technologies, within UI dept, i.e. the introduction of Q-unit, for JavaScript unit testing. – XHTML, CSS/CSS3, Object Orientated JavaScript, jQuery, Q-unit JS unit testing, AJAX, Agile.

HH Global

Nov 2011– Jul 2012: User Interface/User Experience Developer- Agile Coach.

I was engaged by this global print management house primarily to produce the UI and to recommend best practices from a User Experience perspective to a Print Management application, and secondly, due to my agile experience to assist the project manager and offer guidance in adopting Agile/Scrum procedures. - XHTML/HTML5, CSS/CSS3, Object Orientated JavaScript, jQuery, AJAX, Agile.

ASOS

Sept 2011 – Nov 2011: User Interface Developer.

This was a short term contract for this leading online fashion house. I was tasked with producing their online lookbook that is available to the trade and fashion press to show their up-coming collections, producing the front end and adding functionality to work cross browser and cross platform including Tablets. - XHTML/HTML5, CSS/CSS3, Responsive Design/ Media Queries, JavaScript, jQuery, AJAX.

BBC

Oct 2010 – Sept 2011: Client Side Developer/Technical Consultant.

I was working for the BBC's FM&T (Future Media & Technology) division, specifically working on the My Web My Way site www.bbc.co.uk/accessability, among my responsibilities were to add functionality to the site, in particular;

1. Object Orientated JavaScript that modifies the DOM and therefore the user experience, according to choices of disability type, operating system and browser, made by the user.
2. Converting legacy JavaScript that switches stylesheets and text size according to the user's choices, from the BBC's Glow JavaScript library to jQuery.
3. The addition of a JavaScript client side search functionality.

5. The addition of social media sharing tools.

I was also part of the remit to prepare the site for migration and to migrate the site on-to the BBC's Web Application Development Platform (Forge)

The main skills/techniques used on this contract were. – Object Orientated JavaScript, JSON, jQuery, AJAX, CSS, XHTML.

LBi

Aug 2010 – Oct 2010: User Interface Developer.

This was a short term contract for this leading digital media agency. I was engaged on finalising, polishing the front end and adding additional functionality to an extranet application that provided a management and data entry system for the Tourism Ireland Website. - XHTML, CSS, JavaScript, jQuery, AJAX.

Employment: EMC Consulting/Conchango

Aug 2004 – April 2010 Technical Consultant/ Interface Developer

I was working as a Senior Technical Consultant for 5-6 years, working on many prestigious projects for some blue-chip companies. When I started at Conchango I was 1 of only 2 permanent front-end/interface developers and as such worked on many and varied projects, from large internet sites to intranet sites and specialised web applications, I will list some of the larger or more interesting projects I worked on during this time, in chronological order, giving a brief description of the project my role on it and the technologies used.

Barclays – 2010: This project was to create a new personal banking portal for this large high street bank. Working within a team based at Barclays offices near Canary Warf we were tasked with creating an interface with rich interactions. - XHTML, CSS, JavaScript, MVC, jQuery, AJAX.

Johnston Press– 2010: The brief on this project was to produce modular page layouts that could be branded for the various Johnston Press Titles and to provide a user interface to the Atex production system that was being rolled-out across their publications. Also to write the necessary JavaScript to provide the rich interactions required. - XHTML, CSS, JavaScript, jQuery.

Aviva – 2009: I was tasked together with a Flash Developer with the production of a CD/DVD based interactive Demo that could showcase the various Aviva products to their financial advisers. - XHTML, CSS, JavaScript, jQuery.

Moneysupermarket.com – 2009: I worked within a team of developers to provide the CSS XHTML expertise to style this SharePoint based On-line insurance application form and the provide JavaScript interactivity. - XHTML, CSS, JavaScript, jQuery, AJAX.

Associated news – 2009: Based within the Associated News offices In Kensington, I produced modular mark-up, CSS and JavaScript functionality, to enable the Java developers to create this heavily form based Intranet application to manage the advertising for the Daily Mail and Mail on Sunday. - XHTML, CSS, JavaScript, jQuery.

Visa – 2008 – 2009 This project was to produce a POC for a new interactive secure payment gateway for Visa that would allow the user to choose what card or method they wished to use. - XHTML, CSS, jQuery, XML, XSLT, AJAX.

River Island – 2008: I was one of a team producing this large e-commerce site for this clothing retailer. I was tasked with creating page layouts, styling and interactions required by the designers and UE architects. This project followed on from the work done on Harrods.com. - XHTML, CSS, JavaScript, jQuery.

Vodafone – 2008: We were a small team, tasked with producing prototypes and practical examples of mark-up, styling and interactions, against this companies new Style Guide of its e-Services division, prior to its roll out across the whole of Europe. - XHTML, CSS, JavaScript, jQuery.

Harrods.com – 2007: On this project I led a team of front-end developers in producing four interfaces on the same back-end the e-commerce website, a call centre application to work in parallel with the website, a wedding list application and a content management system for this large prestigious retailer. Conchango produced a code base from this project which it named DCP (Digital Commerce Platform) that was based on ASP.NET and Microsoft Commerce Server. - XHTML, CSS, JavaScript, jQuery.

HiFX - 2006 – 2007: This project based in Windsor for this global foreign exchange company, was to produce page layouts and styling plus functionality around the Sitecore content management system for all their sites globally. - XHTML, CSS, JavaScript, CMS.

Virginmobile.com – 2006: I was one of two front-end developers working in a large team, tasked with providing page layout styling for the launch of this large website for this mobile phone operator. - XHTML, CSS, JavaScript.

Lloyds.com – 2005: I was lead UI developer on this project which based in the Lloyds building in London; this project involved the re-branding and production of page layouts, style sheets and functionality for the launch of the web site for this large insurance organisation. - XHTML, CSS, JavaScript.

Self Employment – Contracting 1987 - 2004:

During this period I worked as a contract Front-end Developer/User Interface Developer, working for a number of companies including: LEIS (learn easy internet solutions), TenTen Digital, DNA Consulting, Euro RSCG Wnek Gosper, Victoria Real, Pittard Sullivan, Williams Lea New Media. Working on a number of web/intranet/extranet sites for several companies including: NUS, Worldvision, Intel, newwoman online, bigbrother, BT, KPMG, EBRD, Warburg Dillon Read, Morgan Stanley and Rothschild.